

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Climate change has been affecting the weather around the globe. Let's do something before it's too late!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about extreme weather conditions.
- I can discuss how to deal with problems.
- I can ask for help or advice.

Ask your partner:

- How different is the weather now compared to when you were a child?
- What do you do to keep updated about the weather? Go online? Watch the news?





Let's Explore!

Sally asks a climate change expert about the **worst case scenario*** we are facing on the planet.

* The "worst case scenario" is the the most negative outcome.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Brock, as a weather expert, could you explain to us how the weather patterns have been changing recently?
- Brock Tameland:** We have been studying the effect of climate change for a while, and we have noticed a worrying trend all around the globe. The weather has become more unpredictable than ever. Drought has been affecting large portions of the American continent, while flash floods and hurricanes have been wreaking havoc on the coastal areas and marshlands.
- Sally:** Can you tell us what causes these changes?
- Brock Tameland:** Our refusal to tackle the problem of carbon gas emissions has not helped the situation. The earth is simply finding it harder and harder to breathe!
- Sally:** What would happen if we didn't do anything about this?
- Brock Tameland:** The consequences would be disastrous if we didn't change our behavior. We are facing a global crisis: harsh winters and scorching summers every year, insufficient crops ...
- Sally:** That sounds terrifying. Do you know what we should do to avoid this scenario?
- Brock Tameland:** I would urge everyone to be aware of the waste they produce every day and try to reduce it. People should reuse what they have and recycle what they don't need instead of throwing everything away. That would be a good place to start.





Let's Practice!

Sally asks Brock about weather patterns!

Instructions: Match the phrases on the right with the ones on the left to form sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| 1. Could you explain to us how | a. we should do to avoid this scenario? |
| 2. Can you tell us | b. on this map the areas most affected? |
| 3. What would happen | c. the weather patterns have been changing recently? |
| 4. Do you know what | d. what causes these changes? |
| 5. Could you show us | e. if we didn't do anything about this? |



Let's Practice!

How can we deal with environmental problems?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Complete them by selecting the correct answer from below.

- The consequences ____ be disastrous if we didn't change our behavior. would / will / will not
- If we don't stop creating CO2 the earth ____ be able to breathe. won't / will / wouldn't
- If we don't start to tackle the problem of climate change, the weather will continue to be _____. unpredictable / predictable / predict
- What ____ happen if we didn't do anything about this? would / won't / will
- If we don't _____ more, we will continue to have more environmental problems. bicycle / drive / fly





Extension Activity

Make a poster to show how you could make the environment better.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Brainstorm ideas on how to make the environment in your city better.
- Write down your ideas. Use modals of suggestion with conditionals to make sentences.
- Then go on the Internet or cut out pictures from magazines in order to make a poster for all of your suggestions. (Find at least 8 to 10 pictures)
- Hang your posters on a wall and present your ideas to your classmates using suggestions.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I talk about the environment.

☐ ☐

I discuss how to deal with problems.

☐ ☐

I ask for help or advice.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- weather pattern** (noun): weather conditions that repeat themselves on a regular, predictable basis
e.g. The weather patterns have been changing recently.
- to tackle** (verb): to make an effort to deal with something
e.g. Our refusal to tackle the problem of carbon gas emissions has not helped the situation.
- hurricane** (noun): a storm with violent winds, usually coming from tropical areas
e.g. Hurricanes have caused great damage to coastal areas.
- to wreak havoc** (expression): to cause great damage; to cause chaos
e.g. Hurricanes have been wreaking havoc on the coastal areas.
- marshland** (noun): land consisting of low-lying wet areas
e.g. Flash floods have been affecting the marshlands.
- disastrous** (adjective): causing great damage; catastrophic
e.g. The consequences would be disastrous if we didn't change our behavior.
- to urge** (verb): to persuade, encourage or strongly advise
e.g. I would urge everyone to be aware of the waste they produce every day and try to reduce it.





Learning Points

Discussing How to Deal With Problems

When you want to offer advice or give solutions to a problem, you use modals like *might*, *should* or *could*.

You use the first conditional sentences with *If* clauses to talk about real possibilities in the future.

You use the second conditional to talk about unreal or imaginary (hypothetical) situations in the future.

The modals can go at the beginning of the sentence, or after a clause starting with "*If ...*"

Example:

If ... , I would/I wouldn't ...

If ... , you could / should ...

You use the First Conditional to say it's possible that you will do or not do something. In that condition, something else may, will or will not happen.

The parts of the sentence are divided into two clauses: the *If* clause and the *Condition* clause.

You use the Second Conditional to talk about unreal or hypothetical situations. You're not certain that it's possible to fulfill the condition.

Example:

If I had a million dollars, I would travel around the world.

Do you have a million dollars? No.

Is it possible to suddenly get a million dollars? Not really.

What would you do if you had a million dollars? Travel around the world.

You use *if* + *the Simple Past*, then *would* in the result clause.

Examples:

• **Ann:** *What would happen if we didn't do anything about this?*

Bob: *The consequences would be disastrous if we didn't change our behavior.*





Learning Points

Asking for Help or Advice

There are several ways to ask for help or advice in English. You can use polite and casual language to do this. Let's look at one particular structure for asking for help or advice.

You can use the structure:

Can / Could / Do + you + verb + me (optional) + question word

Examples:

Could you explain to us how the weather patterns have been changing recently?

Can you tell us what causes these changes?

Do you know what we should do to avoid this scenario?

Can / Could / Do	you	verb	(me/us)	question word
<i>Can</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>tell</i>	<i>us</i>	what <i>causes these changes?</i>
<i>Could</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>explain to</i>	<i>us</i>	how <i>the weather patterns have been changing recently?</i>
<i>Do</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>know</i>		what <i>we should do to avoid this scenario?</i>

